

> **"The pace needs to improve at some sites and in few aspects. We will do it"**
>
> **N. CHANDRABABU NAIDU**
> *Chief Minister, Andhra Pradesh*

jobs, a real estate boom and other big opportunities to accompany the rise of a grand capital.

That dream was put on hold when Naidu lost the 2019 state election and Yuvajana Sramika Rythu Congress Party (YSRCP) chief Jagan Mohan Reddy took over as CM. Jagan wanted three capitals instead of one: Amaravati as the legislative capital, Kurnool in Rayalaseema as the judicial capital and Visakhapatnam as the seat of government, for which he even built the Rs 450 crore Rushikonda Palace as his camp office. That diffused focus meant work on Amaravati came to a grinding halt. The firms Naidu had engaged for his dream project—from a Singapore consortium of companies to the Hyderabad-based infra major, NCC—began withdrawing from the project. An eerie silence fell on the construction sites, the foundational structures submerged in rain water every monsoon, with thick overgrowth engulfing some stretches, including the near-complete legislators' and All India Services officers' residential complexes. Seeing their prospects perish, farmers went on a 1,631-day strike, seeking justice.



TAKING SHAPE Construction of the GAD-HoD towers in progress

PRASAD NICHENAMETLA

A CAPITAL IN THE MAKING

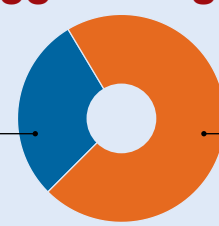
The spread and key features of Naidu's dream capital

TOTAL AREA

53,251 acres
(216 sq. km)

15,396 acres Govt land

37,855 acres Pvt land



16,666 acres
Additional land being pooled for an International Sports City, a new railway station and the Inner Ring Road

Figures are rounded off

ICONIC TOWERS

1
GAD* Tower
50 storeys, including CMO and rooftop helipad

4
HoD Towers
40 storeys for heads of departments

** General Administration Dept.*

INTEGRATED SECRETARIAT COMPLEX

129
Core infrastructure and building projects
planned across housing, trunk infrastructure, land-pooling-sector infrastructure, the assembly, high court and GAD/HoD towers

CAPITAL MOVES AGAIN

By June 2024, Naidu was back in the saddle. Two years on, the 216 sq. km expanse is pulsating with construction activity.

The Integrated Secretariat Complex will have five iconic towers. Four, each 40 storeys tall, will house heads of departments (HoDs); the fifth, a 50-storey structure, will accommodate the General Administration Department (GAD), including the CM's office, and have a rooftop helipad. Called the GAD-HoD towers, they are being built by three major firms: NCC is building the CMO-GAD tower, Shapoorji Pallonji HoD 1 and 2, and L&T the remaining HoD towers. Moved out of Hyderabad lock, stock and barrel in 2016, government offices are now scattered across Vijayawada and the adjacent towns of Mangalagiri and Tadepalli, with several operating out of rented buildings.

Seated at the swanky, new office